

## RISKS OF THE INTERNET OF THINGS AT HOME

### RECOMMENDATIONS FOR THE SAFE USE OF THE INTERNET OF THINGS

The device does not distinguish who its user is: it can capture and store voices/images/information from people without their knowledge (family members, guests, etc.).

In addition to the data we provide directly and consciously, devices incorporate sensors to capture and store other data such as images and audio.

Many companies involved in providing the service (device manufacturers, software developers, service providers, etc.) may have access to our data and process it for further purposes.

By combining the collected data with information from other users, it is possible to deduce information regarding our habits, behavior, and/or physical condition.

Some devices can track our movements and, at a minimum, can locate us in specific places for certain periods of time.

The volume of data collected and the combination of information from various devices allows for the creation of accurate profiles based on our habits, preferences, and the use we make of the devices.

Even when we are not directly and consciously interacting with the device, it may continue to capture and process personal data.

An Internet-connected device with insecure settings, defaults, or unresolved vulnerabilities can become a gateway for cybercriminals to access our personal data.

Personal data is processed by third parties who, in the event of a security breach, may be exposed.

Televisions, toys, robotic vacuum cleaners, light bulbs, alarms, speakers, or doorbells are just a few examples of devices that can operate connected to the Internet.

When we use smart devices at home, we may incur some risks to our privacy and that of those who live with us or visit us. Knowing these risks is key to avoiding them.

Follow these recommendations to improve your privacy if you use smart devices:

1. The fundamental right to data protection also depends on you:

- Think about what data is necessary for each device; do not provide more data than necessary.
- Review the information provided by the manufacturer and if you have doubts, consult their data protection officer.
- Give your consent only for purposes that align with your preferences and needs.

2. Choose products from manufacturers or providers that offer guarantees of privacy and data protection, and those that commit to providing security updates throughout the product's lifespan.

3. Before purchasing the product, inform yourself through the privacy policies of:

- a. Who will process your personal data and how you can contact the data protection officer,
- b. What types of data will be processed and for what purposes,
- c. Whether your personal data will be communicated to third parties and for what purposes,
- d. How to exercise your data protection rights, including your right to data portability.

4. During setup, make sure to review and configure your preferences and privacy and security options. You should be able to give your consent or express your opposition to the various purposes. Change default users and passwords. Ensure that the device is updated. Disable functionalities that you will not use.

5. While you have the device in use:

- a. Check that the device can be disconnected when you are not using it, and use the mode that allows you to disable data capture.
- b. Periodically review the privacy and security options.
- c. Install available security updates.

6. When you stop using the device permanently:

- a. Do not keep an obsolete, unused, or outdated device connected to the Internet.
- b. You have the right to request the deletion of your personal data, and it is advisable to delete user accounts with service providers you will not continue using.
- c. You can also exercise your right to data portability.

d. Erase any data the device may contain before selling or recycling it.

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